

We would like the government to take cognisance of the specialised high-end imported steel required for pipelines. Just securing your steel players is not enough. I hope the steel Bill takes this fact into cognisance and is able to distinguish between high-end steel and others.

India has a lot of steel mills, and they don't concentrate on this high-grade steel. It (the levies on imported steel) will give us a big disadvantage in the global market. We are also in touch with all the steel mills on how to expand their basket.

Today, India is importing a million tonnes steel for oil and gas for re-export. The government must give certain benefits and certain criteria to make sure that the pipe market doesn't go dry and special grade steels are handled differently. We shouldn't get bogged down by our own policies.

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You have been working towards dignity for people with reduced mobility. What's next for Svayam?

Right now, we are really concentrating on the Commonwealth Games (to be held in Ahmedabad in 2030)—particularly the para games. We are not ready with different modes of transport, sensitising people, and accessible infrastructure for para-athletes. We need to work towards making the transport, hotels, stadiums, and places of recreation accessible for everyone. We are working with the sports ministry and are hopeful things will work out.

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What is your strategy for the rest of FY27 and the outlook ahead?

We're looking at diversifying and concentrating on other areas. We've got all types of coatings and offshore projects. So, things like that keep us afloat. Other investments everywhere else are also doing fairly well. And we are hopeful that more pipe plans will come in, but the shipping routes need to open.

Pipelines are going to be something that will be demanded all over the world because everybody is realising that their overdependence on Hormuz is a negative. So, the world is already looking at the Red Sea and cross-country pipelines and is not waiting only for transportation through ships.

In India, there is focus on PNG connectivity, ONGC getting into exploration work, and alternative gases coming into the picture. The carbon capture pipelines are going to come. Hydrogen may not be in its purest form but in mixed form. So, a whole lot of different thinking in terms of (oil and gas) transport is on the cards.

India has announced Samudra Manthan worth ₹86,000 crore for deep-sea exploration, and this will give immense opportunities for offshore (pipeline) supplies. BT

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NOTE *The rank is based on* BT*'s proprietary methodology involving profit after tax, profit growth, and operating profit margin, focusing on profitability as the key metric to judge performance*